PEARSON EDEXCEL INTERNATIONAL GCSE (9–1) · ENGLISH LANGUAGE B · 4EB1/01

Rapid Revision Summary

Last-minute review · condensed from 17 papers and 16 mark schemes, Jan 2019 – Jun 2026

THE PAPER

Q	Task	Marks	Time
1, 2	retrieve from Text One	1 + 1	2 min
3	how the writer presents … (T1)	10	15 min
4, 5	retrieve from Text Two	1 + 2	2 min
6	how the writer presents … (T2)	10	15 min
7	compare both texts	15	12 min
8	directed writing, both texts	30	60 min
9–11	argument / story / description	30	60 min

3 hours · 100 marks · reading time for each text ≈ 7 min. Plans are not marked.

TOP 10 MARK-LOSERS

- Short answers from **outside the line range** score 0.
- Q3/Q6: retelling content instead of analysing **how** it is written.
- Naming a technique with **no effect** on the reader.
- Long quotations; references must be **brief and embedded**.
- Ignoring **sentence structure** and **whole-text structure** (Level 3+ needs both).
- Q7: one text only = **max 6/15**. Unbalanced references.
- Q8: missing a **bullet point**; ignoring one source text.
- Q8: wrong **register** or mixed forms (letter conventions in a talk).
- Section C: re-telling the source texts; plot in a description.
- Comma splices, it's/its, their/there, no paragraphs.

ASSESSMENT OBJECTIVES

AO	Rewards	Qs
AO1	select and interpret ideas	1, 2, 4, 5, 8
AO2	language and structure effects	3, 6
AO3	compare ideas, perspectives, methods	7
AO4	form, tone, register for audience	8, 9–11
AO5	vocabulary, sentences, SPaG	8, 9–11

LEVEL 5 KEY WORDS

Q3/6: **perceptive** analysis; **discriminating** references.

Q7: **varied and comprehensive** comparisons; **balanced** references.

Writing: **perceptive and subtle**; **sophisticated** register; vocabulary used **strategically**.

SHORT ANSWERS (Q1, 2, 4, 5)

- Read only the lines/section named.
- One fact per mark; a short phrase or a quotation is fine.
- Q5: two **different** points.

Q3 AND Q6: LANGUAGE ANALYSIS

EACH POINT

Technique / word → brief quotation → what it suggests → effect on reader → writer's purpose.

Work through the text in order: opening, middle, ending. 6–8 points in 15 minutes.

Feature	Credited effect
word choice	"breathtaking": amazement; "suddenly": shock
simile / metaphor	"slashed as if with a giant knife": dramatic force
list / tricolon	range, variety, sensory overload
contrast	startling differences; problem → hope
"you / we"	involves, includes, reassures reader
questions, imperatives	make reader think; confident advice
statistics, experts	shock; authority, credibility
anecdote, 1st person	relatable, authentic, trust
humour, informal tone	engages young readers
short sentence, repetition	emphasis; memorable ending
headings	clear, organised advice
semantic field	builds a mood (e.g. heavenly light)

MODEL SENTENCE

The violent simile "slashed as if with a giant knife" suggests a land shaped by enormous force, so the reader shares the narrator's awe.

Q7: COMPARISON

COMPARE ON

genre/form (novel vs travel book; blog vs article) · **viewpoint** (first person, advisory) · **purpose** (inform, persuade, entertain) · **attitude** (positive vs critical) · **language** (imagery, humour, statistics) · **structure** (headings, chronology, endings)

- Every paragraph: one idea, **both texts**, a quotation from each, a connective (whereas, similarly, in contrast, both).
- Ideas and perspectives as well as techniques: what each writer thinks and why.

- Never Text One then Text Two then one sentence of comparison.

MODEL SENTENCE

Whereas the narrator of Text One mostly observes ("towering cliffs"), Bryson makes himself part of the scene ("sweatily perplexed"), so the reader feels both the view and the effort.

Q8: DIRECTED WRITING

30 MARKS

AO1 10: all three bullets, ideas from **both** texts, transformed. **AO4 12:** form, tone, register. **AO5 8:** accuracy.

Form	Must show
talk	greeting, "you/we", questions, signposts, "Thank you for listening"
letter to friend	"Dear …", warm personal tone, advice, "Best wishes"
letter to paper	"Dear Editor", clear stance, evidence, "Yours faithfully"
article / website	headline, sub-headings, hook, direct address, conclusion

- Plan 10 min: three bullets as headings; 3–4 source ideas each + 1–2 of your own.
- Write 45 min: 5–7 paragraphs. Check 5 min.
- Rework ideas for the audience; do not copy sentences.

SECTION C (≈ 400 WORDS)

Q9 ARGUMENT

Stance in line one → 2–3 developed reasons with examples → counter-argument answered → conclusion echoing the opening. Examiner is the audience: confident, formal.

Q10 STORY

Start in action → one complication → turning point → resolution linked to title (title may come only at the end). Small cast, short time span. Dialogue, senses, varied pace.

Q11 DESCRIPTION

No plot. Organise by place or time; senses; precise nouns and verbs; one mood; a returning image. End by echoing the opening.

Recent titles: The Turning Point · A Difficult Decision · The Short Cut · The Future · The Reunion · The First Impression · The Missed Message · Lost and found.

AO5 IN ONE BOX

SHOW OFF ACCURATELY

Precise vocabulary ("trudged", "luminous"), not "very nice".

Punctuation range: colon, semicolon, dash, one well-placed question.

A short sentence after a long one; fronted adverbials; deliberate lists.

Topic sentences, linking words, an ending that echoes the opening.

FINAL 60 SECONDS

- Line ranges for short answers.
- Q3/Q6: quote → effect → purpose; include structure.
- Q7: both texts in every paragraph.
- Q8: three bullets, both texts, the right form.
- Section C: plan first; proofread last.